



hoerbox-feeder

User Guide – how to fill the nine buttons with music, audiobooks, and podcasts, with no cables or SD card involved.

For parents & anyone using hoerbox-feeder day to day · 2026 edition

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1 What is hoerbox-feeder?

hoerbox-feeder is a small web page that runs on your home WiFi. You paste a link there from your phone, tablet, or PC – e.g. from YouTube, Spotify, or a podcast – and assign it to one of nine colored buttons. hoerbox-feeder downloads the content, converts it into a consistent audio format, and makes it automatically available to the player. New episodes of a playlist or podcast then arrive on their own afterward – you don't have to repeat anything.



Your phone/tablet/PC and the player need to be on the same WiFi.

2 Adding a link

This is the path you'll use most often:

1. Copy a link – e.g. from the YouTube or Spotify app, or from a podcast page.
2. Paste it into the field on the home page (via the clipboard icon, or just type it in).
3. Tap one of the nine color buttons.
4. Tap "Add".

The screenshot shows the 'hoerbox-feeder' app interface. At the top, there are navigation links: Home, Storage, Edit, Library, Setup, and Logs. The main heading is 'Add something'. Below it, there is a 'Paste a link' section with a text input field containing the URL 'https://www.vorleser.net/hoerbuch/download/die-sterntaler'. To the right of the input field are two icons: a clipboard and a close button (X). Below the input field is a section titled 'Which button?' with a 3x3 grid of color buttons. Each button has a colored circle, a label, and a small number in a grey box. The buttons are: Purple (22), Red (27), Dark Blue (3), Green (2), Yellow (1), Turquoise (4), Light Blue (0), Orange (0), and Dark Green (0). The 'Turquoise' button is highlighted with a blue border. At the bottom of the screen is a large blue button labeled 'Add'.

Color	Count
Purple	22
Red	27
Dark Blue	3
Green	2
Yellow	1
Turquoise	4
Light Blue	0
Orange	0
Dark Green	0

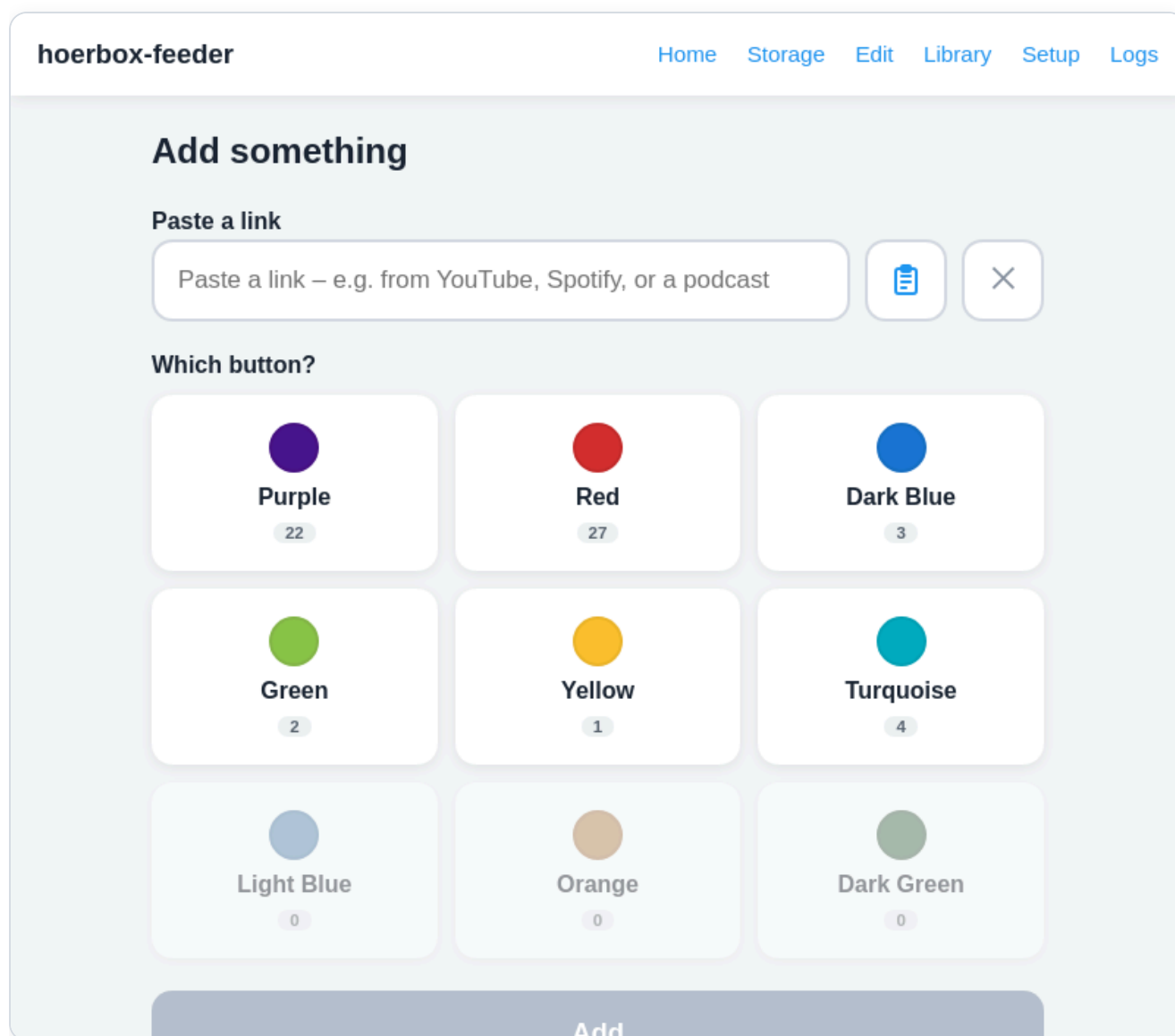
Link pasted, "Turquoise" button selected – the "Add" button becomes active.

You'll then see a progress display: first "Preparing ...", then "Loading ... X%", and briefly "Converting to audio ..." at the end. Once it's done, the title shows up under the button you chose.

If it turns out to be a whole playlist or podcast feed rather than a single title, hoerbox-feeder detects that automatically and sets up a **subscription**: new episodes are then fetched automatically going forward, without you having to paste the link again (more on this in chapter 4).

3 The nine buttons

On the home page you see all nine buttons with their color and – in small text underneath – how many titles currently sit there. A button can also be **deactivated** (shown grayed out): useful, for example, when that button is played externally on the device, say from an SD card, and you want hoerbox-feeder to leave it alone (see chapter 9).



Six active buttons with an item count, three deactivated (grayed out).

4 Inside a button's view

Tap a button to see all its titles. For each title, you have these options:

- ▶ **Play** – plays the whole title right in the browser (tap again to stop).
- ≡ (**handle on the left**) – drag to reorder.
- → **Library** – parks the title without deleting it (see chapter 6).
- → **other button... + Move** – puts the title on a different button.
- ✕ – permanently deletes the title.

If a title belongs to a playlist or podcast subscription, all its episodes are grouped into a **block** (expandable/ collapsible), with the same actions also available for the whole block at once. The **Fetch new episodes automatically** switch turns automatic fetching on or off for that button – when it's off, existing episodes stay, but nothing new arrives on its own anymore.

The button's header also lets you move the **entire button's content** to the library, or delete it all, in one go:

hoerbox-feeder

[Home](#) [Storage](#) [Edit](#) [Library](#) [Setup](#) [Logs](#)

Turquoise

Total playtime: 13 min

☐ Fetch new episodes automatically

Move all to library

Delete all titles

≡

die-sterntaler

01_die-sterntaler.mp3

2 min

→ Library

→ other button... ▾

Move

≡

der-hase-und-der-igel

02_der-hase-und-der-igel.mp3

8 min

→ Library

→ other button... ▾

Move

≡

Beispiel-Hörspiel (Demo)

Failed: HTTP Error 404: Not Found

next automatic attempt at 22:02

Try again now

Find another source

Search myself

→ Library

→ other button... ▾

Move

≡

Anderes Hörspiel (Demo)

↻ alternate source – please check

demo.mp3

3 min

→ Library

→ other button... ▾

Move

Search myself

✓ looks good

[← Back](#)

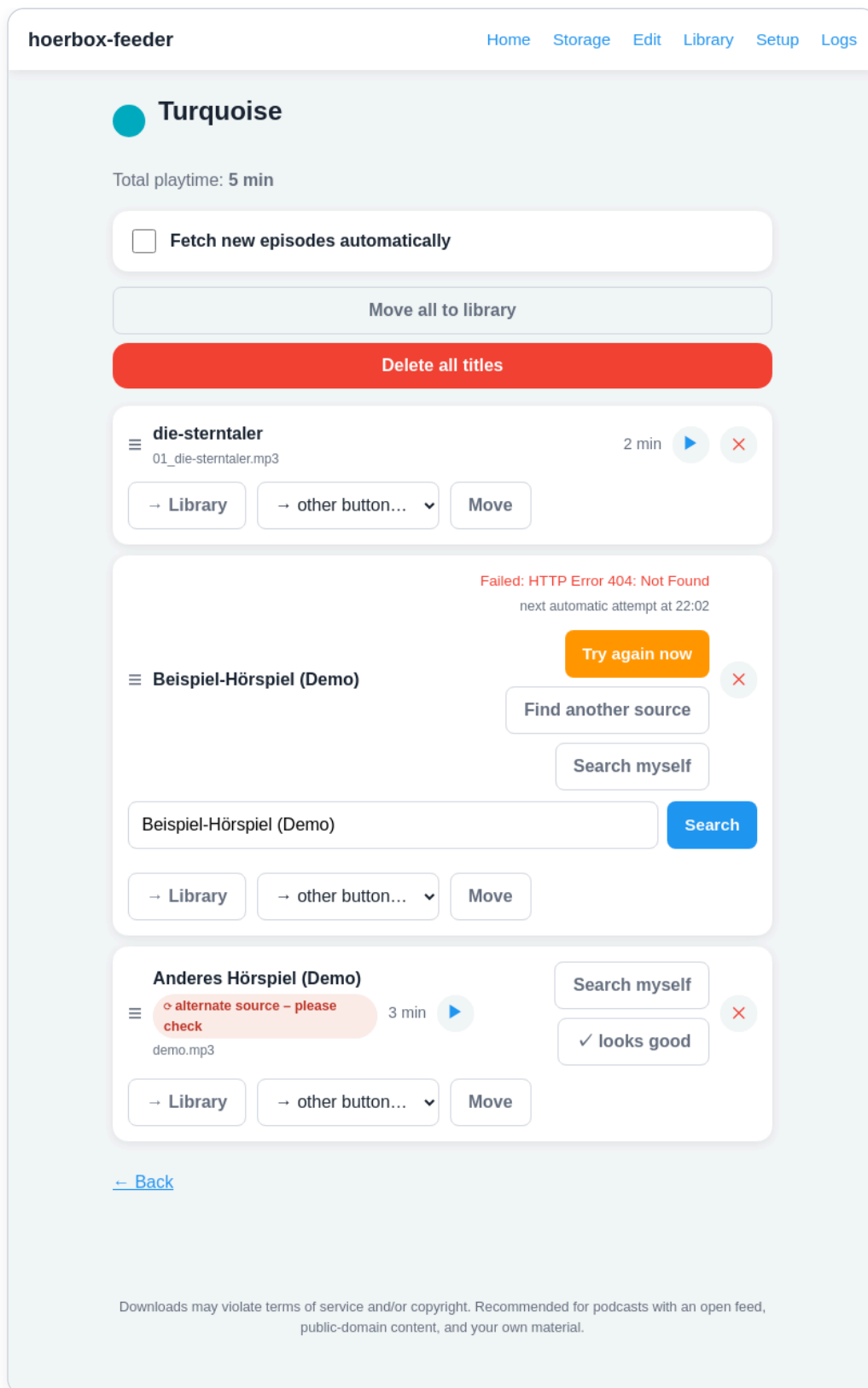
Downloads may violate terms of service and/or copyright. Recommended for podcasts with an open feed, public-domain content, and your own material.

Button view: two finished titles, one failed title, and one title with an automatically found replacement source – every action at a glance (example content, public domain).

5 When something doesn't work

Sometimes a link fails to load (e.g. because the video was deleted). The title then shows a short error message and offers:

- **Try again now** – an immediate retry with the same source.
- **Find another source** – hoerbox-feeder automatically searches for a replacement with the same title (appears only after an automatic second attempt has already been made).
- **Search myself** – you enter your own search term and pick the right one yourself from up to five results (with thumbnail, name, and length).

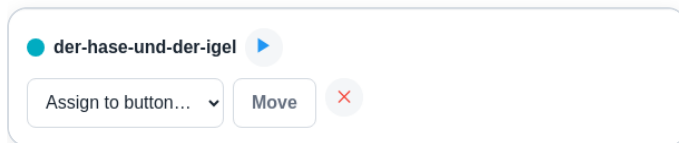


"Search myself" opens an input field right below the affected title.

If a replacement source was found automatically (without anyone reviewing it), the title shows the hint **ⓘ alternate source – please check**. A quick listen is usually enough to tell if it's right – tapping **✓ looks good** dismisses the hint afterward.

6 Library

The library is a holding area for titles and playlists that shouldn't be assigned to a button right now, but also shouldn't be deleted. From there, every entry can be assigned to a button, played, moved, or permanently deleted at any time.



A parked title in the library.

7 Storage & SD-card export

The Storage page shows how much space is used in total and per button, with every individual file available to listen to or delete. If your player is loaded via an SD card instead of WiFi, the **"Download for SD card"** button at the top downloads all titles as a ZIP file, already sorted into numbered folders 0–8 – just unzip and copy onto the card.

Turquoise

(2 Dateien, 9.9 MB)

▶ 01_die-sterntaler.mp32.2 MB✕

▶ 02_der-hase-und-der-igel.mp37.6 MB✕

Delete all (Turquoise)

Storage for one button with two files.

8 Edit

"Edit" is the quick way to a specific button, with small warning hints right on the tile: a red number shows titles currently having a problem, a  chip shows automatically found, not-yet-reviewed replacement sources.

hoerbox-feeder[Home](#)[Storage](#)[Edit](#)[Library](#)[Setup](#)[Logs](#)

Edit

Which button would you like to edit?


Purple


Red


Dark Blue


Green


Yellow


Turquoise

1

 1


Light Blue

inactive


Orange

inactive


Dark Green

inactive

Downloads may violate terms of service and/or copyright. Recommended for podcasts with an open feed, public-domain content, and your own material.

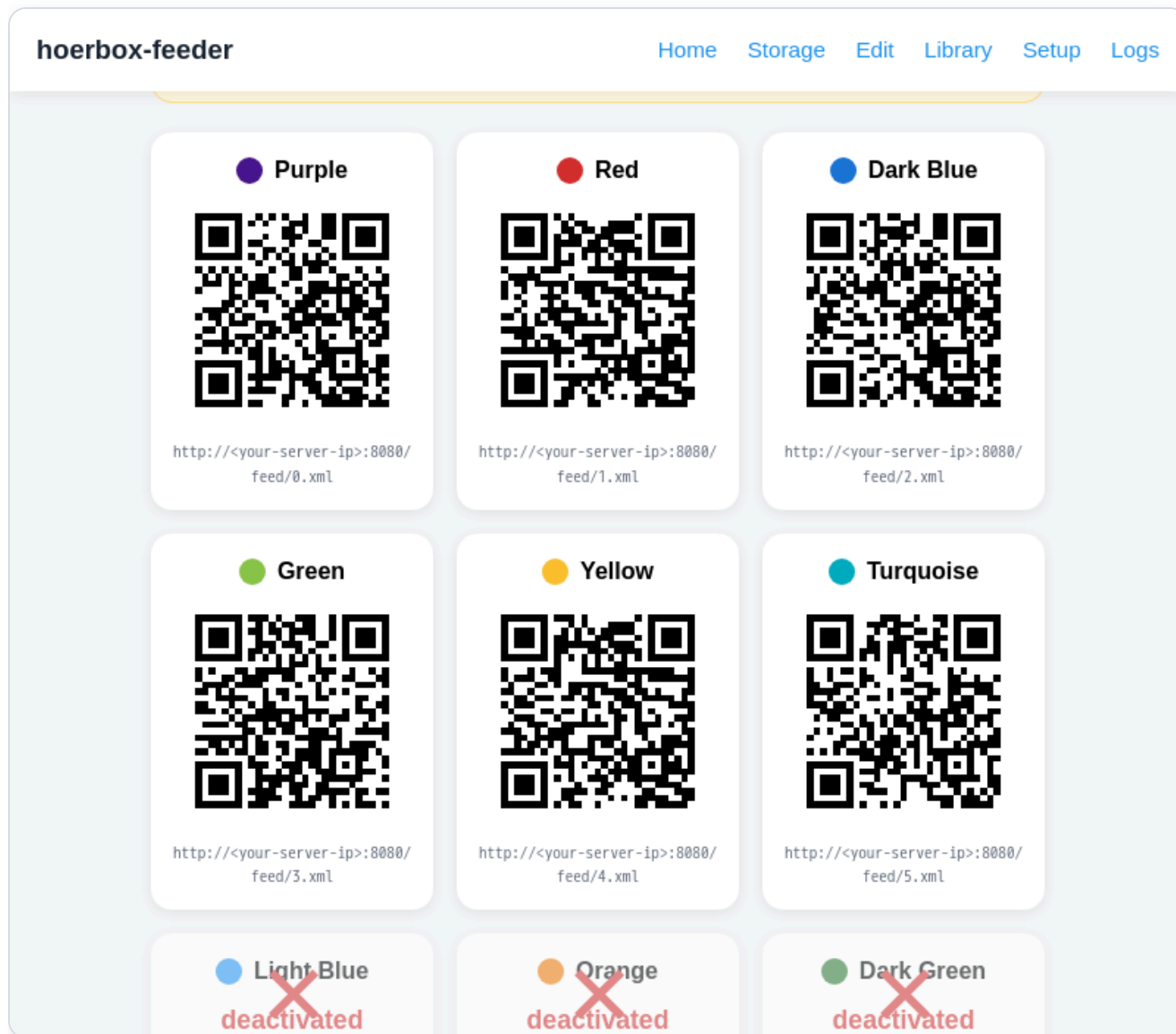
A button with one problem title and one replacement source still awaiting review.

9 Setup

The Setup page is mainly meant for one-time setup:

Addresses for the device

Every button has its own address (as a QR code and as text), entered once into the player or a podcast app. New titles then appear there on their own afterward.



Every button gets its own address to enter once.

Deactivating a button

Is a button already playing external content (e.g. from an SD card)? You can deactivate it here by clicking its QR code. hoerbox-feeder then leaves it alone so nothing gets mixed up.

Settings

Five values can be adjusted here for the whole app:

Maximum downloads

How many episodes should a playlist or podcast load at most at once? The rest follows automatically over time.

Save

Maximum playlist length

How many episodes should be kept per button at most? As new ones arrive, the oldest ones beyond that limit are deleted automatically.

Save

Audio output

☒ Mono ☐ Stereo

Save

Language

☐ German ☒ English

Save

Button display

☒ Colored buttons ☐ Numbered buttons

Save

Maximum downloads

how many episodes of a playlist/podcast load at most the first time – the rest follows automatically over time.

Maximum playlist length

how many episodes are kept per button at most – older episodes beyond that are automatically moved to the library (not deleted).

Audio output	mono or stereo for new downloads. Already-loaded titles keep their existing audio channels.
Language	German or English – switches the whole interface, immediately after saving.
Button display	colored buttons (default) or numbered buttons – shows all nine buttons neutral/gray with a number (1–9) instead of a color name, for hörbert variants without colored keys.

In numbered-button mode, every button – shown here on the home page – shows just a number instead of a color/color name.

The screenshot shows the 'hoerbox-feeder' web interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links: Home, Storage, Edit, Library, Setup, and Logs. The main content area is titled 'Add something'. Below this, there's a section 'Paste a link' with a text input field containing the placeholder 'Paste a link – e.g. from YouTube, Spotify, or a podcast'. To the right of the input field are two buttons: a blue button with a document icon and a gray button with an 'X' icon. Below the input field, there's a section 'Which button?' containing a 3x3 grid of buttons. Each button has a dark gray circle at the top, a label (Button 1 through Button 9), and a small number below it. The numbers are: Button 1 (22), Button 2 (27), Button 3 (3), Button 4 (2), Button 5 (1), Button 6 (3), Button 7 (0), Button 8 (0), and Button 9 (0). At the bottom of the grid, there's a blue button labeled 'Add'.

If YouTube downloads are being blocked, you can also upload a YouTube access (cookies file) here – a green checkmark at the top of the Setup page shows whether that's already set up.

10 Legal notice

Downloads from streaming platforms may violate their terms of service and/or copyright. You are solely responsible for using hoerbox-feeder only with content you're permitted to use – e.g. podcasts with an open RSS feed, public-domain content, or your own material.

11 Questions & help

For questions, bugs, or ideas, the best contact is whoever set up hoerbox-feeder for you.